ACTIVITY - 2

- Make a chart to show the availability of seasonal fruits in your area.

3.6 Fruits

Fruits are formed from flowers and they are the ripened ovary or ovaries of a flowering plant together with the adjacent tissues. Most fruits are fleshy and pulpy or juicy and are pleasantly sweet and have a distinct appealing flavour when ripe. Fruits provide several health benefits and eating the recommended amount of fruit every day can reduce the risk of chronic diseases.

3.6.1 Nutritive value of fruits

Fruits contain high amount of moisture, hence they are highly perishable. They are also good sources of fibre. Apples, pears, cherries, grapes and citrus fruits contain flavonoids which act as antioxidants.

Fruits particularly citrus varieties and guava are a good source of vitamin C. Gooseberry is the richest source of vitamin C.

Yellow fruits like mango and papaya contain β carotene. Banana is a good source of carbohydrate and energy. Fruits are a poor source of protein and fat with the exception of avocado.

Fruits also contain fibre and minerals such as sodium, potassium and magnesium. They are not a good source of calcium. Dry fruits and Seetha phal (custard apple) contribute appreciable amounts of iron.

3.6.2 Classification of fruits

Fruits can be classified as:

Berries: Strawberries, gooseberries, blackberries, raspberries, blueberries, cranberries

Citrus fruits: Sweet limes, oranges, tangerines, sour oranges, lime, lemon, grape fruit.

Drupes: Apricot, sweet cherry, peach, plums

Grapes: Green grapes, black grapes, seedless grapes

Melons: Musk melon, water melon

Pomes: Apples, pears

Tropical and Subtropical fruits: Gooseberry, avacado, banana, dates, guava, jack fruit, mango, jambu fruit, papaya, passion fruit, pineapple, pomegranate, sapota, Seetha phal (custard apple).

3.7 Pigments in vegetables and fruits

Vegetables and fruits are appealing because of their bright and variable colours which are due to pigments present in the plastids of plant cells. The chief pigments of vegetables and fruits can be classified as water soluble and fat soluble.

Fat soluble/ Lipophilic pigments	Water soluble/ Lipophobic pigments
Chlorophyll	Anthocyanin (red/ blue/purple)
Carotenoids (red, orange and yellow)	Flavones& flavanols (yellow) Flavanals etc.

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